

Set a threshold to suppress alert generation

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- ⌚ 4 minutes to read

The event threshold is the rate upon which Event Management generates an alert. Receiving multiple events for a device over a short interval may warrant creating an alert, as the condition may be serious. However, receiving events over a longer interval may indicate a less serious situation which would not warrant creating an alert.

Before you begin

Role required: evt_mgmt_admin

About this task

You can configure the properties in an event rule to create alerts, suppress alert generation, or close existing alerts according to a specified threshold. The threshold is based on the value of event fields or number of occurrences over a specified period.

Note:

Field Name can be the name of any numeric field in the Additional information field of the event. Therefore, if `CPU` is an additional information field for a specific event, then `CPU` can be used as a Field Name.

Assume that you want to generate an alert when CPU utilization reaches or exceeds 80% three times with no more than 20 seconds between any two consecutive events. Create an event rule with these settings (an explanation for each value is given in parentheses):

- Create Alert Operator: `>=` (operator to determine whether utilization of Field Name reaches or exceeds the specified value)
- Field Name: `CPU` (events regarding high CPU usage)
- Threshold Value: 80 (percent)
- Occurs: 3 (three events occur where the CPU usage is at or above "`>=`" 80%)
- Over(seconds): 20 (20 seconds or less between events)

To demonstrate how the preceding settings are evaluated, assume that the following events are received:

Scenario	Outcome
Reported elapsed time and the CPU usage for each event: • First event elapse time 20, CPU=85 • Second event elapse time 40, CPU=80 • Third event elapse time 60, CPU=70	In this scenario, no alert is generated since one event has a CPU utilization that is under 80%.
Reported elapsed time and the CPU usage for each event: • First event elapse time 20, CPU=85 • Second event elapse time 40, CPU=90 • Third event elapse time 70, CPU=95	In this scenario, an alert is not generated since the elapsed time in one event is over the specified 20 seconds.
Reported elapsed time and the CPU usage for each event: • First event elapse time 20, CPU=85 • Second event elapse time 40, CPU=95 • Third event elapse time 60, CPU=90	In this scenario, an alert is generated since in all events the elapsed time is within the specified time and the CPU usage is over 80%.

Note:

- When configuring an event rule to create or close alerts according to a threshold, events that arrive at the same second, as determined by the time_of_event field, are skipped. This occurs because these events are considered to be duplicates.
- When threshold conditions are configured, alerts close when the Close Alert Operator condition is met, and not when an event is received with Severity = Clear or Resolution state = Closing.

Procedure

1. Navigate to All > Event Management > Rules > Event Rules.
2. Create or open an event rule.
3. Click Threshold.
4. Select Active.

If Active is not selected, the fields on this page do not appear.

5. In the Create Alert Operator field, select an operator.
 - If you select Count, specify the corresponding Occurs and Over(seconds) fields.
 - If you select any operator other than Count, the Field name and Threshold value fields appear. Specify the required values in these fields.

Note:

The value of the Threshold value property can be the name of any field in the Additional information of the event. For example, if CPU is a field in Additional information for a specific event, then CPU can be used as the Threshold value.

- In the Occurs field, specify the required value.
- In the Over(seconds) field, specify the required period.

6. To automatically close alerts, in the Close Alert Operator field, select an operator.

Extra fields appear according to your selection.

- If Count is specified as the operator for the Create Alert Operator field, then the selection in the Close Alert Operator field is either None or Idle. Specify the required value.
- If you select Idle, configure the Over(seconds) field.
- In the Close Alert Operator field, if you select an operator other than Idle, then configure the Threshold value, Occurs, and Over(seconds) fields.

7. Click Save or Submit.

Example

To create an alert when a specific event occurs 5 times in 10 minutes, in Threshold:

1. In the Field name field, specify the name of any field that exists in the Additional information field in the event. The value of the field is irrelevant.
2. In the Create Alert Operator field, select Count.
3. In the Occurs field, specify 5.
4. In the Over field, 600 (10 * 60 seconds).
5. Click Save or Submit.

To create an alert when a specific event occurs 5 times in 10 minutes with a metric value greater than 55. Assume that "metric_value" is a field in the Additional information of the event. Specify:

1. Select the Active check box.
2. In the Create Alert Operator field, select >=.
3. In the Field name field, specify metric_value.
4. In the Threshold value field, specify 55.
5. In the Occurs field, specify 5.
6. In the Over field, specify 600 (10 * 60 seconds).
7. Click Save or Submit.

Related concepts

- Use event input information

Related tasks

- Create or edit an event rule

- Configure an event rule to customize alert content
- Filter the events that an event rule applies to